

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a three-part setting (Soprano, Alto, and Bass) in 3/4 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with a treble and bass staff. The lyrics are written below the staves, with some words hyphenated across lines. The first system includes three vocal parts with lyrics: '1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,'; '2 Now of my three - score years and ten,'; and '3 And since to look at things in bloom'. The second system continues the lyrics: 'hung with bloom a - long the bough,'; 'tween - ty will not come a - gain.'; and 'fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,'. The third system includes: 'it stands a - bout the wood - land ride'; 'And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,'; and 'a - bout the wood - lands I will go,'. The fourth system concludes with: 'wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.'; 'leav - ing me just fif - ty more.'; and 'see the cher - ry hung with snow.'.

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.